Women's Specialists of Clear Lake
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Laparoscopy

A minimally invasive surgical approach for diagnosis and treatment of gynecologic conditions

WHAT IS LAPAROSCOPY?

Laparoscopy is a minimally invasive surgical technique in which a thin, lighted camera (laparoscope) is inserted through small abdominal incisions to visualize and/or treat internal organs — without the need for a large open incision.

Common Gynecologic Uses:

- Endometriosis
- Pelvic pain
- Ovarian cysts
- Ectopic pregnancy
- Fibroids
- Infertility workup
- Tubal ligation
- Adhesions/scar tissue
- Hysterectomy (TLH)
- Biopsy

LAPAROSCOPY VS. OPEN SURGERY

Feature	Laparoscopy	Open Surgery
Incision size	**3–5 small cuts (5–12mm)**	**Large (4–12 inch)**
Pain level	**Mild to moderate**	**Significant**
Hospital stay	**Same-day or overnight**	**2–5 days**
Recovery time	**1–2 weeks**	**4–6 weeks**
Scarring	**Minimal**	**Significant**
Infection risk	**Lower**	**Higher**

BEFORE YOUR SURGERY

1. **Pre-op appointment:** Labs, EKG if needed, anesthesia clearance, review medications
2. **NPO after midnight:** Nothing to eat or drink after midnight the night before surgery
3. **Medications:** Stop blood thinners and NSAIDs 5–7 days before as directed; continue other medications with a small sip of water
4. **Arrange transportation:** You will need a driver — you cannot drive yourself home after general anesthesia
5. **Comfortable clothing:** Wear loose, comfortable clothes on surgery day

RECOVERY & WARNING SIGNS

Normal After Laparoscopy:

- Mild incision site soreness (1–3 days)
- Shoulder/neck pain from CO_2 gas (resolves in 24–48 hrs)
- Light vaginal spotting or discharge
- Bloating and gas — walk to help it resolve
- Fatigue for several days — rest is important

Recovery Timeline:

- No driving for 24–48 hours (longer if narcotic pain meds used)
- Light activities in 1–2 days; return to work 3–7 days
- No heavy lifting (>10 lbs) or strenuous exercise for 2 weeks
- No sexual intercourse until cleared by Dr. Klein

Call Us Immediately If You Have:

- Fever over 101°F
- Increasing pain not controlled by medication
- Signs of infection at incision site (redness, pus, warmth)
- Heavy vaginal bleeding or unusual discharge
- Difficulty breathing or chest pain

Minimally Invasive — Maximum Results

Dr. Klein has extensive experience with laparoscopic gynecologic surgery. Our goal is to give you the most effective treatment with the fastest possible recovery. Questions before your surgery? Call us anytime at
(281) 557-0300
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